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J. Srinivas, *Future of the BRICS and the Role of Russia and China*
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-1115-6_5

5. Russia and China in BRICS: Convergences and Divergences

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Keywords Russia – China – BRICS – Global South – and International relations

Introduction

Russia and China have successfully sorted out their cross-border immigration and territorial disputes within their bilateral relations. The Russia–China partnership also holds a compatible perspective on territorial integrity, and the two countries consistently denounced separatism within the two countries, such as Chechnya and Taiwan, for instance (Tsigankov 2009). In 2012, on April 30, the Chinese vice premier Li Keqiang remarked at the famous Moscow State University that the relationship between Russia and China had strong foundations from the past, which was a golden opportunity in the present, and considerable potential for the future. However, their relationship with BRICS is quite complicated because of its significance in foreign policies. Both Russia and China are founding members of the BRICS, and both countries share a joint stand. However, both have had their differences; despite this, Russia and China view BRICS as a group with tremendous potential in how it plays a part in development. In the recent past, the changing international relations scenario, particularly after the COVID-19 pandemic, signaled an unprecedented change in world politics. In this context, BRICS will play a crucial role in its upcoming international relations through Russian and Chinese foreign policy.